

SAMSON LAIRD

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SUMMARY

• Security-focused IT engineer with 3+ years of front-line incident response, identity, and endpoint protection in a CUI environment under CMMC Level 2. Triage phishing, malware, and credential compromise end to end (log correlation through containment and root cause), then feeds findings into preventive policy. Authored the System Security Plan covering all 110 NIST SP 800-171 requirements with control register and POA&Ms. Builds Python tooling for detection, scoped testing, and automation. B.S. Cybersecurity (Maryville University, 2025). OSCP in progress.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

• Detection, Monitoring & Response: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint / XDR, Entra ID sign-in and audit log analysis, Microsoft Purview, Forcepoint content filtering, phishing and malware triage, containment and eradication, incident prioritization and escalation, technical reporting

Identity & Authentication: Entra ID, Active Directory, Conditional Access, Intune / Endpoint Manager, Microsoft 365, KeeperPAM, Windows LAPS, credential rotation

Network & Infrastructure: IP-based networking, Cisco Catalyst switching, OPNsense firewall, VPN (Pritunl), Windows Server, Linux, VMware / Proxmox multi-node lab, Prometheus / Grafana monitoring

Documentation & Compliance: NIST SP 800-171, CMMC Level 2, System Security Plan authoring, POA&M development, standard operating procedures, FIPS 140-2/140-3 validation review, technical reporting

Scripting & Tooling: Python, PowerShell, Bash, Git; automation for credential rotation, endpoint policy, and security testing harnesses

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Environmental Restoration, LLC • St. Louis, MO • Oct 2022 – Present

IT Support Engineer • Front-line IR, identity, and endpoint security across a ~300-user organization

- First responder for security incidents: triage credential phishing and malware-bearing email; correlate Entra ID sign-in/audit logs with endpoint alerts to confirm or rule out account compromise; execute containment (session revocation, credential reset, device isolation).
 - Investigate authentication anomalies and user-reported suspicious logins; separate genuine compromise from token, policy, and device-state failures; push confirmed root causes into Conditional Access so individual incidents become standing preventive controls.
 - Explain findings and required remediation to non-technical staff across the business; convert authentication failures, malware exposure, and access changes into instructions that produce correct action without unnecessary escalation.
 - Administer identity and privileged access as engineered controls: KeeperPAM gateway architecture, PAM Machine and Directory records, automated device approval, and LDAPS-backed Active Directory credential rotation; rolled KeeperFill fleet-wide through Intune to eliminate uncontrolled browser credential storage.
 - Perform Microsoft Purview eDiscovery collections across Exchange, SharePoint, and Teams for legal hold and internal investigations, including recovery of content already purged by the originating user.
 - Authored the System Security Plan for CMMC Level 2 / NIST SP 800-171 covering all 110 requirements; maintain the control status register, evidence artifacts, and POA&Ms. Documented assessment-based findings including non-FIPS-validated cryptographic modules in the VPN path as a genuine SC.L2-3.13.11 gap (not vendor claim acceptance) and scoped remediation.
 - Document and improve standard operating procedures for security response and control maintenance; produce technical write-ups that capture findings, outcomes, and hardening recommendations.
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SELECTED PROJECTS

• Independently developed and published; not work product.

Security Operations Homelab • Proxmox multi-node, OPNsense, Linux/Windows targets, Prometheus/Grafana

• Operate a multi-node Proxmox lab with firewall/VPN path (OPNsense), mixed OS targets, and host/service monitoring (Prometheus/Grafana) to practice detection, isolation, and recovery workflows outside production.

Garbleworks • github.com/SamsonCyber/garbleworks

• Authorized LLM red-team and detection harness in Python: composable attack recipes, scoped fire path with rules-of-engagement enforcement, and Wilson-interval success measurement so results carry confidence bounds rather than raw counts. MCP server, HTTP API, and TUI. Built to automate repeatable security tests under hard scope constraints.

Dark Promptery: LLM Prompt-Injection Field Guide • samsoncyber.github.io/llm-injection-field-guide

• Mechanism-first reference of 324 techniques across 20 categories, each paired with the detection or mitigation that neutralizes it. Crosswalked to OWASP LLM Top 10, MITRE ATLAS v5.6.0, NIST AI 100-2e2025, and CWE 4.20.

stegoff / agent-canary / blockjail • github.com/SamsonCyber

Python detection tooling: injection and steganography scanning of untrusted input, honeypot/tripwire alerting for anomalous agent behavior, and a local jailbreak gate for solo LLM apps.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Cybersecurity — Maryville University • 2025

• OSCP — Offensive Security Certified Professional, in progress (PWK/PEN-200 complete)